and their former colonies, one must go through the formalities of negotiations to see whether they accept the principle for establishing diplomatic relations. We must not only listen to what they say, but also see their specific actions. For example, if they do not vote for China in the UN but instead support the reactionary Chiang Kai-shek regime, then we should go slow in establishing diplomatic relations with them.' [34]

The decision by India to sever ties with Nationalist China and to recognize the People's Republic of China might have meant that India was only acknowledging the reality, but it was coupled with a poverty of tactics. If the act of jettisoning Chiang and the Nationalists was unsentimental and calculating, early recognition of the successor regime does not appear to have been motivated by anything more than sentiment and the expectations of goodwill. Had India's position not been driven by emotion and sentiment, the course of the negotiation may have been different with more tangible results. The poverty of tactics was to have irreversible consequences for India. China, on the other hand, started out with a weak hand but crafted a strategy based on clear objectives and proper study of the adversary. There was also a regular review and readjustment of tactics, as when the Chinese paused in early January 1950 to study whether India and Britain were colluding on the matter of diplomatic recognition. Internal decisions were based on facts. They did not proceed on presumption. China never put itself under pressure of time either, unlike India, nor allowed success to be measured in terms of the act of recognition by itself, but rather by securing the opposite side's adherence to the larger principles that it enunciated.

China benefitted significantly from the establishment of diplomatic relations with India. Recognition by India meant that America could not rope India into any anti-Communist front that might encircle China, and friendship with India was